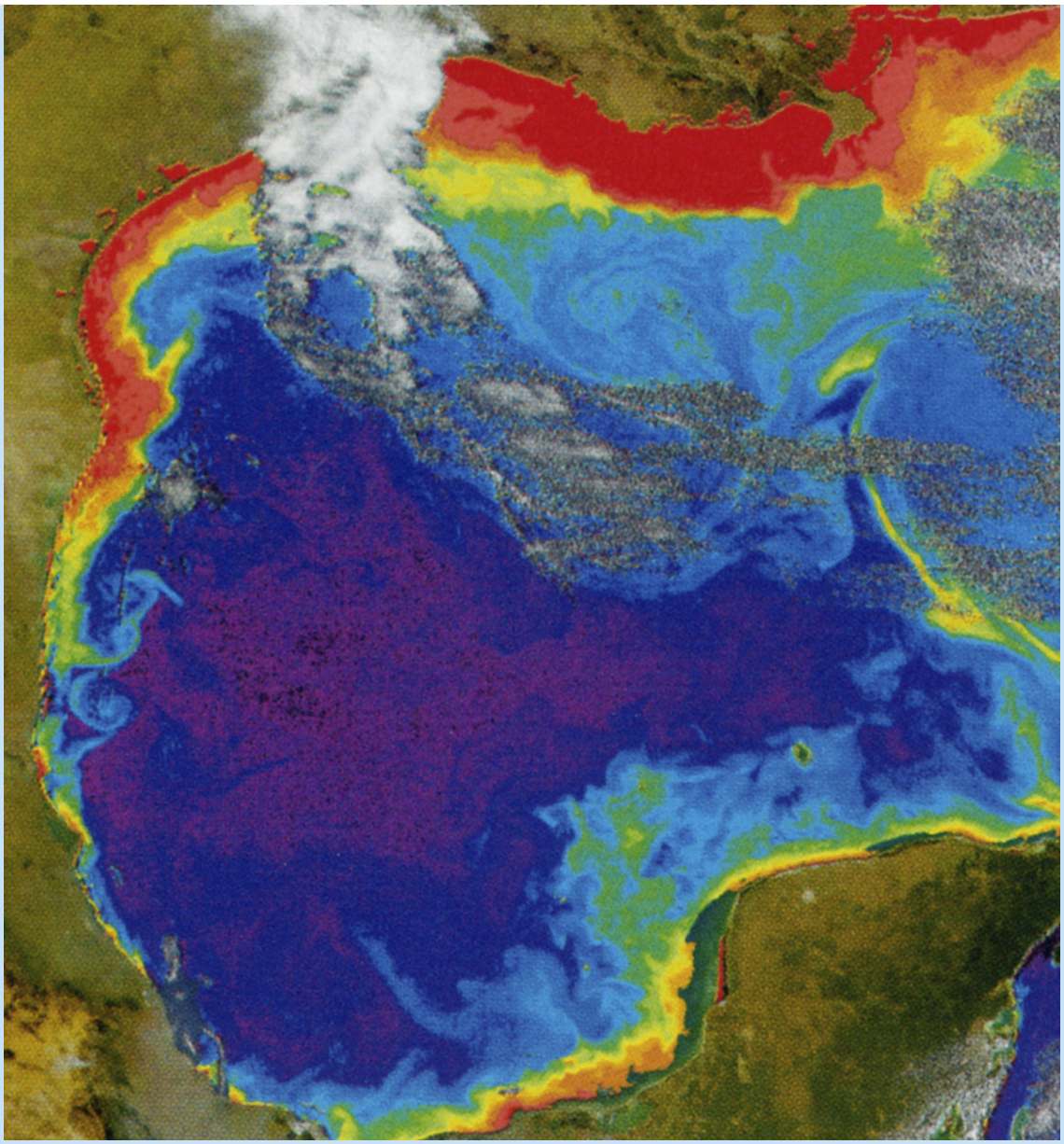


Thick blooms of phytoplankton appear in red on this satellite image of the Gulf of Mexico. Bacteria break down decaying algae, releasing CO_2 and absorbing essential oxygen.

See also: Pollution • Human devastation of Earth • Sustainable Biosphere Initiative • Halting biodiversity loss

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